Mohammed Mehdi Kaebi

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Education

Insper São Paulo, Brazil
PhD in Economics 2022–2027
Dissertation: *Essays in Empirical Asset Pricing*
Advisors: Ruy M. Ribeiro and Marco Bonomo

London School of Economics and Political Science London, UK
Visiting research student, Financial Markets Group 2025
Host: Christopher Polk. Course audited: Asset Pricing
Research assistance on *Stock Prices Under Pressure: How Tax and Interest Rates Drive Seasonal Variation in Expected Returns*, by Kang, Pekkala, Polk, and Ribeiro

Insper São Paulo, Brazil
BSc in Economics 2017–2021
Rank 3 of 111 (GPA 9.31/10.00)

Research Interests

Asset pricing, international finance, financial econometrics.

References

Marco Bonomo
Professor of Economics
Insper
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Ruy M. Ribeiro
Associate Professor of Finance
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Bernardo Ricca
Assistant Professor of Finance
Insper
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Job Market Paper

VIX Futures Term Structure and Currency Returns

I use the VIX futures term-structure to build currency risk factors and show that they are priced in the cross-section of currency returns and carry incremental predictive information for future returns. Currencies with greater exposure to the level and curvature factors earn a lower risk premium, acting as insurance, while those more exposed to the slope factor earn a higher premium. Decomposing the factor returns into news about expected future volatility and news about the variance-risk premium, I find that expected-volatility news carries no price of risk, and that the premia sit in the variance-risk-premium component. A Bayesian factor-selection procedure places the term-structure factors in the stochastic discount factor with high posterior probability. I rationalize these results with a two-agent preferred-habitat model in which experts have horizon-specific volatility hedging demands and arbitrageurs face funding and margin costs.

Award: Best Paper in Asset Pricing, Brazilian Finance Society Annual Meeting, 2026

Presentations: 32nd AEFIN Finance Forum (Pamplona, 2025, also discussant), 26th Meeting of the Brazilian Finance Society (Fortaleza, 2026), 48th Meeting of the Brazilian Econometric Society (scheduled, Foz do Iguaçu, 2026), Insper Macro and Finance Workshop.

Working Papers

Following the Stars: Long-Run Rates in the Carry Trade
with Igor Martins
Under review.

Covariance Implied Risk Factors

Presentations: 33rd AEFIN Finance Forum (Alicante, 2026, also discussant), 26th Meeting of the Brazilian Finance Society (Fortaleza, 2026), FinanceHub (São Paulo, 2026), 10th Vietnam International Conference in Finance (accepted, 2026), Insper Macro and Finance Workshop.

Firm Characteristics and Stock Returns in Brazil
with R. Ribeiro, I. Martins, J. Costa, and T. Nobrega

Presentations: 24th Meeting of the Brazilian Finance Society (Curitiba, 2024), LatAm EQDerivatives* (São Paulo, 2024), FinanceHub* (São Paulo, 2024), Insper Macro and Finance Workshop*.* * Presented by a coauthor.

Work in Progress

Equity Options and the Jump Composition of Exchange Rate Variation

Estimating Prices of Risk Nonparametrically

Commodity Risk in Financial Markets, with Josue Costa

Honors, Awards, and Fellowships

2026	Best Paper Award in Asset Pricing, Brazilian Finance Society *for VIX Futures Term Structure and Currency Returns*
2025	FAPESP PhD Research Internship Abroad Fellowship (BEPE)
2024–2027	FAPESP PhD Fellowship
2024	ANBIMA Capital Markets Prize, Best Finance PhD Thesis Project (BRL 47,600)
2022–2024	Insper PhD Fellowship
2021	Top Performing Undergraduate Student, Insper
2021	Best Undergraduate Paper, Insper

Teaching Experience

2026	Teaching Assistant, *Quantitative Finance* (undergraduate), Insper
2026	Teaching Assistant, *Behavioral Economics* (master's), Insper
2024	Teaching Assistant, *Time Series Econometrics* (PhD), Insper

Professional Experience

2023–2025	**Research Assistant**, Center for Finance and Macroeconomics, Insper Built and maintained the center's data repository and constructed return factors in equity, FX, and commodity markets.
2020–2021	**Macroeconomic Research**, Apex Capital, São Paulo Macro-thematic investment research, forecasting of macroeconomic variables, and analysis of the economic and political environment.

Skills and Personal

Programming	R, Python, LaTeX
Data	Bloomberg, LSEG (Refinitiv, Eikon, Datastream), WRDS (CRSP, Compustat, TAQ, OptionMetrics)
Languages	English (fluent), Portuguese (native), Arabic (conversational)
Citizenship	Brazil